

MORNING BRIEFING — SUNDAY 19 JULY 2026

Generated 07:35 London time (BST) · Data collected 06:15–07:30 BST, 19 July 2026

European and US markets are closed for the weekend. This briefing covers Friday 17 July's European/US close and sets up Monday 20 July's pre-open, since Eurex/ICE/CME futures do not reopen until ~23:00 BST Sunday. Figures marked "Fri close" are the last confirmed session; Monday pre-open futures/Asia levels were not yet available at collection time. Several weekend geopolitical details (see Section 2) are sourced from live-blog coverage and are flagged "unconfirmed" pending Monday wire confirmation.

2. IMPORTANT NEWS

US-Iran ceasefire collapse deepens: US strikes Iran for a seventh straight night; reports of 2 US soldiers killed in a missile strike on a base in Jordan (18 Jul)

[Al Jazeera](#) / [CNN](#) / [Times of Israel](#), 16–18 Jul — the 8 July ceasefire MOU has effectively collapsed; Khamenei has threatened "unforgettable lessons," Trump has floated targeting Iranian power plants/bridges next. The Jordan-casualty detail comes from live-blog coverage and is unconfirmed pending Monday wire (Reuters/AP) confirmation, but the broader trajectory of sustained US strikes is corroborated across multiple outlets. Single biggest tail risk for Monday's open.

Wall Street's "second DeepSeek moment": Chinese lab Moonshot AI's Kimi K3 model triggers a global AI/chip rout

[CNBC](#) / [Bloomberg](#) / [Fortune](#), 17 Jul — Kimi K3 (2.8T-parameter, open-weight) claims to beat GPT-5.5/Claude Opus 4.8 on coding benchmarks, reviving fears over US AI-capex ROI. Philadelphia Semiconductor Index (SMH) fell into a technical bear market, down ~20% from its June record. Nasdaq -1.40% Friday, -2.9% on the week.

Oil surges ~13-14% on the week: Brent near \$88/bbl, WTI near \$82.5/bbl, largest weekly gain in months

[CNBC](#) / [Al Jazeera](#) / [HDFCSky](#), 17 Jul — Kuwait said Iran struck a desalination/power plant; fresh US strikes hit Iranian targets. Directly feeds Monday's inflation/rate-path debate and is the dominant swing factor for airlines, shipping and defense stocks.

Netflix falls 8-12% to a 52-week low on soft Q3 guidance despite an in-line Q2 print

[CNBC](#) / [Fortune](#) / [TheStreet](#), 16–17 Jul — Q2 EPS \$0.80, revenue \$12.56bn roughly in line, but Q3 guidance (\$12.86bn rev vs ~\$13bn consensus; \$0.82 EPS vs \$0.84 consensus) disappointed; shares now down ~21% YTD. A read-through for mega-cap tech risk appetite heading into Alphabet/Tesla earnings Wednesday.

Asian markets tumble Friday as the chip-sector selloff hits the region hardest: Kospi -6.37%, Nikkei -2.79%

[Trading Economics](#) / [AP](#) / [BigGo Finance](#), 17 Jul — Korea's chip-heavy Kospi bore the brunt given its Samsung/SK Hynix memory exposure; Hang Seng was the outlier, closing +1.33%. Sets a fragile tone into Monday's Asian reopen (Tokyo shut Monday for the Marine Day holiday).

3. EUROPEAN FUTURES (PRE-OPEN, FOR MONDAY 20 JULY)

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL / MOVE	NOTES
Euro Stoxx 50 futures	n/a	Eurex closed since Fri 17:00 CET; reopens ~23:00–00:00 BST Sunday; last Friday-session print ~6,326
DAX futures	n/a	Eurex closed over the weekend; last cash close 24,830.98 (-0.34% Fri)
CAC 40 futures	n/a	Market closed; last cash close 8,338.81 (-0.47% Fri)
FTSE 100 futures	n/a	ICE futures closed; last cash close 10,600.37 (+0.27% Fri)
S&P 500 futures	Residual Fri print ~-0.29%	CME Globex closed until ~23:00 BST Sunday; not a fresh weekend indication
Nasdaq 100 futures	Residual Fri print ~-0.94%	CME Globex closed at collection time; not a fresh weekend indication
VIX	18.77 (Fri close)	+12.19% (+2.04pts) Friday, day range 17.68–19.50; elevated but not yet "fear" territory (>20)

No genuine fresh futures indication exists yet at collection time — Eurex, ICE and CME Globex are all confirmed closed until ~23:00 BST Sunday; the S&P/Nasdaq figures above are residual Friday-session prints, not weekend pricing. Recheck after Eurex/CME reopen. The dominant overnight swing factors once futures do reopen: further Iran/Hormuz headlines and follow-through (or reversal) of Friday's AI/chip-sector rout.

4. YESTERDAY'S CLOSES — EUROPEAN INDICES (FRIDAY 17 JUL 2026)

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE	SOURCE
Euro Stoxx 50	6,254	-0.43%	Trading Economics
DAX 40	24,830.98	-0.34% to -0.35%	Armenpress / CNBC
CAC 40	8,338.81	-0.47%	Armenpress / CNBC
FTSE 100	10,600.37	+0.27%	Armenpress / CNBC
STOXX Europe 600	641.53	-0.34% to -0.41%	Stoxx.com / CNBC
FTSE MIB	n/a level	-0.94%	CNBC

European equities fell in sympathy with the global AI/chip selloff and Iran-driven risk-off tone: tech names fell 2.7%, media -1.93%, banks -1.32% region-wide. FTSE 100 was the exception, helped by its defensive/energy tilt as oil spiked. Source: Bloomberg, CNBC, 17 Jul.

5. US MARKETS — YESTERDAY'S SESSION (FRIDAY 17 JUL 2026)

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
S&P 500	7,457.69	-1.01% (week: -1.5%)
Dow Jones	52,146.42	-0.77% (-406.55 pts)
Nasdaq Composite	25,520.24	-1.40% (-361.70 pts; week: -2.9%)

Tone: broad risk-off, Nasdaq's worst weekly close in months as the AI/chip rout deepened. Leading: Energy was the only S&P sector to close higher (oil spike); Real Estate, Consumer Staples, Health Care and Financials held up relatively well. Lagging: Technology was weakest, with Industrials, Materials and Consumer Discretionary also lagging — Applied Materials, Lam Research, Intel, KLA and Arm Holdings each fell ~4%, Micron and Nvidia both down >2%. Key takeaway: Moonshot AI's Kimi K3 model release, plus reports of a delayed Alphabet Gemini 3.5 Pro launch, spooked investors over AI-capex assumptions. Bank-earnings context from the prior week: JPMorgan EPS \$6.14 vs \$5.85 consensus (equity markets revenue +86% YoY), Goldman Sachs record EPS \$20.98 (vs \$10.91 a year earlier), aided by SpaceX IPO fees. Source: CNBC, Bloomberg, Washington Post, The Motley Fool, TheStreet, 17 Jul; SEC 8-K (Goldman Sachs), 14 Jul.

6. ASIAN MARKETS — OVERNIGHT SESSION

INDEX	LEVEL	CHANGE
Nikkei 225	66,835.54 (Fri close)	-2.79%
Hang Seng	25,008.60 (Fri close)	+1.33%
Shanghai Composite	3,882.41 (Fri close)	-1.85%
Kospi	6,820.60 (Fri close)	-6.37%

Monday's Asian session had not opened at collection time; levels above are Friday's close, the last defensible reference point (Tokyo is additionally shut Monday for the Marine Day holiday, thinning early liquidity into the European open). Tone was sharply risk-off ex-Hang Seng: the AI/chip selloff triggered by Moonshot AI's Kimi K3 release rolled through the region first, hitting Korea's chip-heavy Kospi hardest (-6.37%, Samsung/SK Hynix-type memory and AI-supply-chain exposure) and dragging Tokyo down as much as ~5% intraday before it pared to -2.79%. Hang Seng was the outlier, closing higher on mainland-related flows even as Shanghai itself slipped. Source: Trading Economics, BigGo Finance, AP/ClickOnDetroit, Investtech Morning Report, 17 Jul.

7. COMMODITIES

COMMODITY	LEVEL	CHANGE	CONTEXT
Brent crude	~\$88.09-88.10/bbl (Fri close)	+4.6% Fri; +~14% on the week	Iran/Hormuz risk premium: sixth-plus consecutive night of US strikes, Iran hit Gulf targets, Hormuz transits down >50% w/w
WTI crude	~\$82.47/bbl (Fri)	+4.5% Fri	Tracks Brent on the same Iran/Hormuz driver
Gold	~\$4,016.95/oz (Fri close)	+1.03% Fri but -2.5% to -3.2% on the week; briefly broke below \$4,000 intraday	"Safe-haven paradox": oil-driven inflation/yield fears are outweighing geopolitical safe-haven demand; still down ~26% from January's \$5,598 record
Natural gas	Henry Hub ~\$2.92/MMBtu; TTF (Aug) ~€16.3/MWh	Henry Hub +3% w/w; TTF up from ~€15.1 prior weekend	Divergence: TTF lifted by Hormuz supply fears/softer Norwegian output; Henry Hub eased on milder US weather and strong inventories
Copper	~\$6.17-6.22/lb (Fri)	-1.1% to -1.25% Fri; -2.5% on the month; still +12% y/y	Broad metals selloff on Iran-escalation risk-off, partly offset by Chile supply concerns after a major storm

Oil remains hostage to the Strait of Hormuz situation and is the dominant cross-asset driver this week; gold's failure to rally alongside the war-risk headlines is the notable anomaly, as rising yields on oil-driven inflation fears are outweighing safe-haven flows.

8. RATES & FX

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE
US 10Y Treasury	~4.55% (Fri close)	-1bp Fri; spiked to ~4.57-4.60% midweek on the oil surge before easing on a cooler CPI print
German 10Y Bund	~3.14%	Near highest since 20 May; +~0.22pts over the past month
EUR/USD	1.1435	-0.06% Fri
GBP/USD	1.3455 (Fri)	Prev close 1.3476; weekly range 1.3347-1.3548
DXY	100.78	+0.06% Fri; roughly flat on the week (started ~100.63)

Yields whipsawed this week: the Iran-driven oil spike revived inflation concern mid-week, pushing US and German 10Y yields to multi-week highs, before a cooler-than-expected US CPI print pulled Treasury yields back off the highs into Friday's close. Bund yields stayed elevated near their highest since 20 May on similar ECB-hike repricing.

9. DCM — PRIMARY BOND MARKET

RECENT ISSUANCES (WEEK OF 13-17 JUL, PLUS MOST RECENT CONFIRMED SSA/CORPORATE PRINTS)

European Commission — 7th EU-Bond syndication of 2026 (priced ~7 Jul)

€11bn dual tranche: €6bn new 5Y (13 Oct 2031); €5bn tap of 20Y (12 Oct 2046). Order book >€94bn, ~18.8x oversubscribed. Bookrunners: Deutsche Bank, HSBC, LBBW, Morgan Stanley, SG. Source: European Commission press release IP_26_1552, 8 Jul.

IFC — €1bn 7Y green bond, first-ever EUR benchmark (~8 Jul)

Priced "through its dollar curve" per GlobalCapital headline; deal-level spread n/a (paywalled). Source: IFC/World Bank Group press release.

Hines European Core Fund (HECF) — €500m 5Y green senior unsecured, debut public bond (~3 Jul)

Order book >€1.75bn, ~3.6x covered. Expected rating A- (Fitch); HECF rated BBB+ stable. Bookrunners: BNP Paribas, Crédit Agricole CIB, ING (also Sole ESG Structuring Coordinator). Source: hines.com, costar.com.

Realty Income Corp — €600m senior unsecured Eurobond, 3.625% coupon due 30 Jul 2032 (~7 Jul)

Priced at 99.518%. Source: company release.

Societe Generale — dual-tranche EUR Senior Preferred, July 2028 / July 2031 maturities (~1 Jul)

Part of 2026 long-term funding programme; exact size/spread n/a (not disclosed in accessible sources).

US money-centre banks — jumbo EUR FIG trades "unheard of in euros" at elevated new-issue premiums (week of 17 Jul)

GlobalCapital headlines: "US banks expand American-style funding in euros as record issuance beckons" and "US banks spring issuance size surprise." Issuer names and deal-level detail: n/a (paywalled).

Enel Finance International — \$2.5bn multi-tranche senior unsecured USD bond (settled 13 Jul, for context)

Three tranches: \$1,000m 4.625% due 2029 (99.710%); \$750m 4.875% due 2031 (99.545%); \$750m 5.375% due 2036 (98.905%). Order book >\$10bn, >4x covered. Source: Enel press release, ANSA.

EUR high-yield: no deal-level issuance confirmed for the week via open search (GlobalCapital/IFR HY coverage paywalled) — treat as a data-access gap, not necessarily an empty pipeline. Covered bonds: NORD/LB flags a second successive week with no EUR benchmark covered bond deal — the segment has entered a seasonal summer lull.

PIPELINE / EXPECTED WEEK OF 20-24 JUL

BofA forecasts ~\$130bn of USD IG issuance for July 2026 in total (vs \$86bn in July 2025, near the \$131bn 2015 record), driven by an M&A-financing wave after a red-hot H1 (June global M&A value >\$650bn, +71% y/y). The European Commission plans €80bn of further EU-Bond issuance July-December via four syndications and six auctions, though no specific date inside 20-24 Jul was confirmed. EUR IG corporate supply is expected to build further into the week as issuers use the post-Bastille-Day/post-CPI window opportunistically; covered-bond supply likely stays thin through the seasonal lull. No specific named roadshows for 20-24 Jul were confirmed via open search.

KEY SPREADS

INDEX	LAST CONFIRMED LEVEL	AS OF	DIRECTION
iTraxx Crossover 5Y	246bp	9 Jul 2026 (stale, 10 days)	TIGHTENED -5BP THAT SESSION, OIL-DRIVEN RISK-ON
iTraxx Main	n/a	n/a	No reliable date-confirmed July level found; excluded rather than estimated
CDX.NA.IG	n/a	n/a	No numeric July level found via open search
Euro corporate IG avg. OAS (iBoxx €)	~82.6bp	30 Apr 2026 (stale, ~11 weeks)	TIGHTENED FROM ~89BP IN MARCH
Euro HY OAS (ICE BofA)	n/a numeric	Series current to 13 Jul; page inaccessible	n/a

The primary window was open but selectively used: opportunistic and "rare" corporate names, real-estate borrowers (Hines' debut, Realty Income) and, most notably, US money-centre banks pushing jumbo EUR FIG trades at elevated new-issue premiums dominated the tape. GlobalCapital's own framing — "corporate spreads on a knife edge as weight of money balances ugly risks" (17 Jul) — captures the tone: strong technical demand from cash-rich real-money and insurance buyers is still absorbing supply, but NIPs are climbing and books are thinning versus earlier-2026 conditions. Sector skew is toward financials (US banks in record EUR size) and real estate/utilities, with SSA and covered bonds in a seasonal summer lull. A very heavy month overall (BofA's ~\$130bn July USD IG forecast, near the 2015 record) implies the EUR market should stay open into 20-24 Jul, but issuers are likely front-loading ahead of the traditional August slowdown. Terminal-level iTraxx Main/CDX confirmation recommended before relying on spread levels given several data points are stale or unavailable via open search.

10. ECONOMIC CALENDAR (MONDAY 20 JUL 2026)

LONDON TIME	INDICATOR	CONSENSUS	IMPORTANCE
Overnight (before 09:00 CST)	China PBoC Loan Prime Rate decision	1Y/5Y expected held at 3.00%/3.50%; some pricing a 15-20bp cut to the 1Y (would be first cut since Feb)	MEDIUM-HIGH
n/a	Tokyo Stock Exchange closed (Marine Day holiday) — thin Asian liquidity into the European open	n/a	MEDIUM
n/a	No top-tier UK or Eurozone data scheduled Monday; UK CPI is Wed 22 Jul	n/a	—
n/a	No confirmed top-tier US data specifically for Monday	n/a	—

Monday's calendar is light on hard data, so weekend Iran/Hormuz headlines and the AI-selloff follow-through will likely dominate flows. Rest of the week: UK labour market data (Tue, high); UK CPI June (Wed, high); ECB rate decision 13:45 CET / press conference 14:30 CET (Thu, high) — ~88% priced for a hold at 2.25% deposit rate, though ~70% of surveyed economists expect a further hike, likely September; UK retail sales and flash PMIs across Germany/Eurozone/UK/US (Fri, high).

11. CORPORATE EVENTS & EARNINGS

Ryanair (RYAAY / RYA.IR) — fiscal Q1 FY27 results, Monday 20 Jul

First results since jet-fuel costs spiked amid the Iran war; FY26 profit hit a record €2.26bn (+40% y/y) on 208.4m passengers. RBC Capital raised estimates ahead of the print. Source: SEC 6-K, RBC/MarketScreener.

Domino's Pizza (DPZ) — reports 06:05am ET, webcast 08:30am ET

Consensus EPS ~\$4.17 on ~\$1.18bn revenue. Source: Alphastreet, IR.dominos.com.

Steel Dynamics (STLD) — reports after market close Monday

Consensus \$3.68 EPS / \$5.54bn revenue, implying profit up ~80% y/y — a read on US metals demand/pricing. Source: Barchart, Trefis, Benzinga.

Zions Bancorporation (ZION) & AGNC Investment Corp (AGNC) — report Monday

Zions consensus \$1.57 EPS / \$877.1m revenue, options pricing an implied ~4.8% post-earnings move; regional-bank read-through after blowout money-centre bank results the prior week. AGNC consensus ~\$0.38 EPS / ~\$1.06bn revenue, mortgage-REIT sensitive to Fed-cut expectations ahead of the 28-29 Jul FOMC. Source: Investing.com, Benzinga.

Other Monday reporters flagged by aggregators but date-unconfirmed

Crown Holdings, BOK Financial, Calix, SmartFinancial, Wintrust Financial, RBB Bancorp appear in bundled calendar lists without individual confirmation — "unconfirmed, treat with caution." Note: American Express, Verizon and Charter Communications are confirmed for Friday 24 Jul, not Monday, despite appearing in some aggregator summaries. No European AGM or results confirmed for Monday itself; LSEG's own H1 results are 30 Jul.

Week-ahead context: Halliburton, GM (Tue) — Tesla, Alphabet (Wed) — Intel, Honeywell (Thu)

Sets the tone for industrials, mega-cap tech/AI-capex and semiconductors later in the week. Source: CNBC "week ahead."

12. STOCKS TO WATCH

Ryanair (RYAAY) — **VOLATILE**

Reports fiscal Q1 FY27 Monday, first since jet-fuel costs spiked; record FY26 profit vs elevated fuel-cost risk from the Iran conflict. Source: RBC/MarketScreener, GuruFocus.

Steel Dynamics (STLD) — **Up bias**

Consensus implies profit +~80% y/y; a bellwether for US metals demand/pricing. Source: Barchart, Trefis.

Zions Bancorporation (ZION) — **VOLATILE**

Options market pricing an implied ~4.8% post-earnings move; regional-bank read-through. Source: Investing.com.

Frontline (FRO) / tanker names — **Up**

Persian Gulf VLCC spot rates near a record ~\$470,000/day after partial easing of Iran's Hormuz blockade; war-risk insurance premiums still 2-10% of hull value vs ~0.25% pre-conflict. Highly headline-sensitive. Source: Seeking Alpha, gCaptain, Business Insurance.

A.P. Moller-Maersk — **Up**

Raised FY26 underlying EBITDA guidance to \$8-10bn (from \$4.5-7bn) on elevated transpacific freight rates and tariff-driven frontloading. Source: gCaptain, Investing.com.

Lockheed Martin / Northrop Grumman / RTX — **Up**

Rallied on renewed US strike orders and production-restocking commitments (LMT tripling Patriot output, quadrupling THAAD; RTX expanding Tomahawk/AMRAAM lines); LMT also announced the Ultra Maritime acquisition. Headline-sensitive both ways given wider-war risk. Source: Blockonomi, Benzinga, 24/7 Wall St.

JetBlue / US & European airlines — **Down / mixed**

Jet fuel up >120% since hostilities began; JetBlue raised Q2 fuel-cost guidance to \$4.26-4.36/gal. Hedged carriers (easyJet, Air France-KLM, IAG) better placed than unhedged US majors and LCCs. Source: Forbes, Morgan Lewis, White & Case.

Nvidia / AMD / TSMC / Micron / Applied Materials — **MIXED**

Led Friday's selloff (SMH -20% from June record, bear-market territory) on Moonshot's Kimi K3 model, but TSMC posted blowout Q2 (sales +36% y/y) and flagged 5-10% wafer price hikes, lifting 2026 growth guidance above 30% — bearish sentiment overhang vs bullish fundamentals. Source: Bloomberg, Fortune, StartupHub.ai.

Prologis (PLD) / Segro — Up (Segro)

Prologis pushing for talks on a \$16.9bn bid for UK-listed Segro (announced 9 Jul); watch for M&A-arb flows in industrial REIT names. Source: company filings.

13. MACRO / CORPORATE / POLITICAL HIGHLIGHTS

MACRO

Fed Chair Kevin Warsh has held the funds rate at 3.50-3.75% for four straight meetings and dropped forward guidance; May PCE inflation hit 4.1% y/y, the highest in three years, partly on tariff pass-through. Nearly half of FOMC members reportedly now see another hike this year; Goldman has pushed cut expectations to 2027.

ECB hiked 25bp to a 2.25% deposit rate on 11 Jun on Middle-East-driven energy inflation; a hold is expected 23 Jul but ~70% of surveyed economists expect a further hike, likely September.

China Q2 GDP grew 4.7% y/y, undershooting the 5.1% consensus and the slowest pace in three-plus years, pressuring the PBoC toward a possible LPR cut Monday.

VIX closed 18.77 Friday (+12% on the day, +~20% on the week) — an elevated-but-not-yet-"fear" vol regime; US 10Y ~4.55%, gold ~\$4,017/oz.

CORPORATE

Moonshot AI's Kimi K3 release (full weights due 27 Jul) is the dominant corporate story, a "second DeepSeek moment" that hammered US/Asian AI and chip names (Z.ai -30%, MiniMax -16% at one point).

Nvidia has lagged the 2026 semiconductor rally all year (+3.2% YTD vs AMD +171%, Micron +305%) even as the VanEck Semiconductor ETF is +59% YTD, underscoring the market's rotation away from the AI bellwether.

Netflix's guidance miss and Travelers' earnings beat were the standout single-stock moves Friday (energy was the only positive S&P sector).

Q2 earnings season is ramping hard into next week: Ryanair, Steel Dynamics, Zions and AGNC Monday, then GM/Halliburton (Tue), Tesla/Alphabet (Wed), Intel/Honeywell (Thu).

POLITICAL / GEOPOLITICAL

US-Iran conflict has reignited: the 8 July ceasefire MOU collapsed, US strikes continue nightly, a naval blockade/transit-fee regime on the Strait of Hormuz has resumed, and reports (unconfirmed, live-blog sourced) describe 2 US soldiers killed in a Jordan missile strike 18 Jul. Trump has threatened to target Iranian power infrastructure next; Netanyahu has warned of further escalation.

US-EU trade deal now in force since 1 Jul (EU removed duties on US industrial goods; most EU exports to the US face a 15% tariff); US-China truce holds a 30% combined tariff with a pause. USTR's Section 301 completion deadline (12.5% duties on 46 countries) falls Monday 20 Jul as the temporary 10% Section 122 tariff sunsets 24 Jul.

Pharma-tariff onshoring deadline 31 Jul (threatened 100% branded-pharma tariff cut to 20%, 15% for EU) and a Section 301 Germany investigation comment deadline 10 Aug are upcoming trade-policy flashpoints.

Fed independence remains a live political story: Powell recently called Trump's pressure on the Fed a "stress test" for central-bank independence, even after his own departure and Warsh's confirmation.

14. KEY THEMES — TOP 5 BY HORIZON

TODAY'S TOP 5 (MONDAY 20 JUL)

- 1. Iran/Hormuz escalation over the weekend** — US strikes hit Iranian infrastructure as recently as 18 Jul; the ceasefire MOU collapsed 8 Jul. Oil, shipping and airline stocks open reacting to any fresh weekend headline.
- 2. AI/chip-stock "DeepSeek moment 2.0" hangover** — watch for follow-through selling or a dip-buying bounce after Friday's SMH bear-market close, ahead of Wednesday's Alphabet/Tesla earnings.
- 3. Oil levels after a >14% weekly surge** — Brent ~\$88, WTI ~\$82.5 as of Friday; any weekend de-escalation or re-escalation moves energy, airline, shipping and inflation-sensitive names sharply at the open.
- 4. Q2 earnings kickoff for the new week** — Ryanair, Steel Dynamics, Zions Bancorp, AGNC and Domino's report Monday, setting sector tone right after last week's blowout bank results.
- 5. USTR Section 301 tariff deadline (today)** — completion deadline for proposed 12.5% duties on 46 countries as the 10% Section 122 surcharge sunsets 24 Jul; a live trade-policy risk for importers/multinationals.

THIS WEEK'S TOP 5 (20-24 JUL)

1. Alphabet & Tesla earnings, Wed 22 Jul — Alphabet consensus EPS \$2.86 (+23.8% y/y), Cloud backlog >\$460bn; Tesla consensus EPS \$0.51 after record Q2 deliveries. Sets direction for the semis/AI trade after Friday's selloff.

2. ECB rate decision, Thu 23 Jul — a major cross-check on global central-bank policy just before the Fed's own 28-29 Jul meeting.

3. Dense industrial/defense earnings slate — RTX, Lockheed Martin, Honeywell, Union Pacific, GE Vernova, 3M, GM, IBM, Texas Instruments, Comcast, Intel, T-Mobile, Danaher, Northrop Grumman, Halliburton and others report through the week — a broad read on capex, tariff pass-through and defense restocking.

4. Section 122 global tariff sunset, 24 Jul — the 10% surcharge expires; markets watch whether the Section 301 replacement is finalized in time or a policy gap emerges.

5. Iran/Hormuz conflict trajectory — with the ceasefire collapsed and strikes ongoing, any diplomatic development or fresh strait disruption is the single biggest swing factor for oil, shipping, airlines, defense and Fed rate-cut odds this week.

THIS MONTH'S TOP 5 (JUL/INTO AUG 2026)

1. FOMC meeting, 28-29 Jul — decision Wednesday 2pm ET, no Summary of Economic Projections this cycle; elevated oil-driven inflation complicates the rate-cut path.

2. Q2 earnings season progression — record bank profitability (JPM, GS) sets a high bar; the AI-capex/ROI debate reignited by Moonshot's Kimi K3 will be tested through late-July mega-cap tech and August guidance.

3. Trade policy cliff-edge — Section 122 sunset (24 Jul) into Section 301 replacement duties, plus a pharma-onshoring deadline (31 Jul) — a persistent overhang on importers/multinationals into August.

4. Iran war / Strait of Hormuz — the dominant geopolitical flashpoint of 2026, running since February with repeated ceasefire attempts collapsing; ~20% of global oil flows transit Hormuz, keeping war-risk insurance and tanker/airline economics structurally elevated.

5. AI infrastructure spending debate — TSMC's blowout results/wafer price hikes vs the Moonshot-driven "DeepSeek moment 2.0" scare; hyperscaler capex guidance in late-July earnings will shape semiconductor and AI-adjacent equity performance into August.

15. KEY TRENDS TO WATCH

1 DAY

Weekend Iran/Hormuz headlines are the dominant swing factor for Monday's open once futures reopen Sunday evening; follow-through (or reversal) of Friday's chip-sector selloff; reaction to Ryanair, Steel Dynamics, Zions Bancorp and AGNC earnings; USTR's Section 301 tariff-completion deadline; oil opens after last week's >14% surge with VIX closing 18.77 Friday, signalling elevated hedging demand.

1 WEEK

Alphabet and Tesla earnings (Wed) for AI-capex and delivery/margin signals; ECB rate decision (Thu); a heavy earnings slate spanning RTX, Lockheed Martin, Honeywell, Union Pacific, GE Vernova, 3M, GM, IBM, Texas Instruments, Comcast, Intel, T-Mobile, Danaher, Freeport-McMoRan, Newmont, Northrop Grumman, Blackstone, Thermo Fisher, CSX, AT&T, Philip Morris International, CME Group, ServiceNow, SAP and Halliburton; June new home sales (Fri); the Section 122 tariff sunset (24 Jul); and continued Iran/Hormuz developments likely to keep oil, shipping and airline volatility elevated.

1 MONTH

FOMC meeting and rate decision (28-29 Jul), key given elevated oil-driven inflation risk; the pharma-onshoring tariff deadline (31 Jul); the ongoing Iran war/Strait of Hormuz conflict as the primary geopolitical tail risk for energy, shipping, aviation, defense and gold through the month, with no resolution in sight; the AI capex/ROI debate maturing through remaining Q2 tech earnings and August guidance updates; and the broader Q2 earnings season conclusion testing whether record bank profitability and strong industrial/metals results can offset tariff and geopolitical cost pressures across sectors.

Sources: Reuters, Bloomberg, CNBC, Al Jazeera, CNN, Times of Israel, The Motley Fool, TheStreet, Fortune, Washington Post, Yahoo Finance, Benzinga, Trading Economics, Investing.com, BigGo Finance, AP/ClickOnDetroit, Investtech, Armenpress, Stoxx.com, HDFCSky, Seeking Alpha, gCaptain, Business Insurance, Forbes, Morgan Lewis, White & Case, Blockonomi, 24/7 Wall St., StartupHub.ai, European Commission, IFC/World Bank Group, hines.com, CoStar, Enel, ANSA, Bloomberg Law, NORD/LB, FRED, State Street, GlobalCapital, Alphastreet, Barchart, Trefis, GuruFocus, RBC Capital/MarketScreener, Earnings Whispers, Federal Reserve, ECB.
Data collected automatically. Verify before making any decision.